

"LAST-CHANCE TOURISM"

A Double Edged \$word?



What is it?

- Also known as "Doom" Tourism, the term describes the increased interest to see a phenomena or landscape before it's gone forever - largely as a result of the changing environment due to Climate Change [1].
- Excursions are promoted throughout the tourism industry [1].

Why the Arctic?

Climate Change

- Arctic **warming 4x faster** than the global average [3]
- Expected to be ice-free by 2050 [3]
- Implications on environmental features and wildlife.



Wildlife

- Western Hudson Bay Polar Bear subpopulation **decreased by 22%** from 1988-2004 [1]
- Species became an iconic symbol of climate change.



Incentivises the "see it before it's gone" mentality.

Why is it a Problem?

Tourism Carbon Footprint

- Hard to get into the Arctic = Carbon Dioxide intensive (CO₂) travel.
- Polar Bear Viewing trips generate **1.54-8.61 tonnes of CO₂ per tourist** [2].
- Growing Sector: Churchill Manitoba Polar Bear Tourism **2018 CO₂ emissions = 23,017 tonnes** (10% increase from 2008) [2].
- Creates a **Positive Feedback system** -> accelerates environmental degradation.
- **Loss of Habitat =**
- **Loss of Wildlife =**
- **Loss of Indigenous Traditional Ways of Life [3]**

CO₂

Check it out below



Local Indigenous Communities

Communities divided between stopping tourism and encouraging it as a source of income

Pond Inlet, Nunavut Inuit

Population 1,600
Received 3,000 tourists 2023 [3]

FOR

- Crucial income
- Revenue used to fund infrastructure (eg. Woman's Shelter).
- Cannot rely on traditional hunting practices for food = need the revenue
- Increases awareness and can reduce stereotypes surrounding Inuit way of life.

[3]

AGAINST

- Declining engagement of young people in traditional practices.
- Increase in marine activity detracting wildlife and changing migration routes.
- Noise in Arctic waters travels further than those in Temperate.
- Lobbying efforts by Mittimatalik Hunters and Trappers Organization (MHTO) to limit activity.

"Where there are big boats, there are no mammals. We have no farming, no agriculture here; we need to hunt" - David Qammanig chair of MHTO [3]

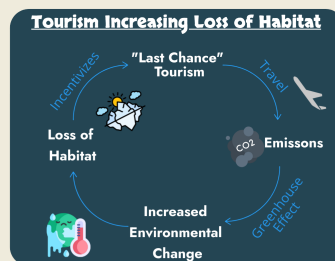
Arctic shipping grew 7% a year over past decade [3]

Success:
Cruise ships restricted from traveling beyond Pond Inlet = Mitigates impacts on Narwhal routes [3].



Positive Feedback Loops

POSITIVE FEEDBACK INCREASES CHANGE



What Can We Do?

1. Promote less Carbon Intensive travel and "slow travel"

"Slow Travel" = spending longer in one location with greater engagement with local communities/economies [2].

Churchill re-introduced **train** from Winnipeg

- roundtrip **0.058t** instead of **0.21t of CO₂** [2].

2. Increase Awareness

Lack of Awareness - 73% of tourists agreed air travel contributes to Climate Change but did not associate their behavior with it [2].

References:

<https://docs.google.com/document/d/1Pee9Rv-8UqoHlL1XYqstH2SeQZ49X0mKSG3Ts7n0/edit?usp=sharing>
Icons used are from flaticon.com and pictochart